

John Goodwin
Head of Engineering

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Engineering leader specialising in scaling teams, platforms and delivery capability to build reliable software products that customers depend on.

Career Highlights

- Head of Engineering for organisations of up to 120 software and quality engineers
- Scaled engineering capability from 1 team to 16 squads within 3 years
- Led the consolidation of multiple airport booking and operational platforms into shared, scalable platforms
- Modernised legacy systems while maintaining delivery momentum and customer outcomes
- Introduced AI-assisted engineering practices across software development teams
- Transformed engineering delivery through an internal open-source model, improving collaboration, ownership, quality and delivery speed
- 24+ years delivering digital products, SaaS platforms and customer-facing software

I have over 24 years of experience building software products, leading engineering teams and helping organisations scale. Over the past 16 years, I have focused on creating engineering organisations that combine strong technical capability with a culture of ownership, collaboration and measurable improvement.

At CAVU (part of Manchester Airports Group), I jointly lead an engineering function of 16 squads, growing the organisation from 10 to around 120 engineers. I have led platform modernisation, engineering transformation and AI adoption initiatives, while partnering closely with Product, Design and business stakeholders to deliver better experiences for customers and improved outcomes for the business.

Key Skills & Technical Expertise

- **Engineering Leadership:** Building and scaling engineering organisations, setting technical direction, improving delivery capability and developing strong engineering teams
- **Product & Business Alignment:** Partnering with Product, Design and senior stakeholders to translate business goals into effective engineering strategies
- **People & Culture:** Developing leaders, coaching engineers, organisational design, career frameworks and performance management
- **Technical Strategy:** Platform architecture, modernisation, cloud platforms, DevOps practices, CI/CD, reliability and technical governance
- **Change & Transformation:** Engineering operating models, agile delivery, internal open-source and domain-driven approaches, and adoption of new technologies

- **Engineering Effectiveness:** Using metrics, feedback loops and delivery data to improve team performance, quality and customer outcomes
- **AI Adoption:** Driving practical AI adoption across the software development lifecycle to improve productivity, quality and engineering effectiveness
- **Technical Background:** AWS, cloud platforms, modern JavaScript/TypeScript ecosystems, REST APIs, CI/CD, GitHub Copilot, Claude

Professional Experience

Head of Engineering - CAVU (Manchester Airports Group)

April 2023 - Present | Manchester, UK

- Jointly leads a department of 16 engineering squads across multiple international products and platforms.
- Grew the engineering function from **10 to ~120 permanent staff** through strategic recruitment, leadership development, and creating an environment where engineers could thrive.
- Led a major transformation to an **internal open-source delivery model**, removing silos between front-end and back-end teams.
- Introduced a modern **engineering career framework**, embedding mentorship, learning, and clear growth paths.
- Delivered critical modernisation projects across e-commerce, booking, and operational platforms, improving reliability and scalability.
- Partnered with UX and Product leadership to **redesign six global airport websites**, consolidating them into a shared codebase to reduce cost and improve maintainability.
- Led the practical adoption of AI-assisted engineering across the organisation, embedding tools such as GitHub Copilot and Claude into development workflows. Improved productivity, code quality and delivery speed while establishing responsible AI practices.
- Championed engineering practices focused on reliability, accessibility, security and maintainability, ensuring platforms could scale while meeting the needs of diverse users.
- Worked closely with Product, Design and operational teams to deliver customer-facing platforms used internationally, balancing user needs, business priorities and engineering sustainability.
- Currently driving a platform evolution towards micro-frontends, enabling smaller, more frequent releases while improving deployment speed and team autonomy.

Technical Lead - CAVU (Manchester Airports Group)

Oct 2021 - April 2023 | Manchester, UK

- Led and managed the Extranet team to ensure efficient, effective delivery of the Extranet projects within the new Single Platform
- Drove a culture of technical excellence and test-driven development (TDD), improving release confidence and velocity
- Collaborated with Product and Delivery to align engineering goals with business priorities

- Worked closely and liaised with Delivery Managers and Product Owners to agree strategy, estimations and successful outcomes
- Introduced **frontend standards and shared component libraries** to improve consistency across brands
- Focused on best practices and standards
- Encouraged team motivation to help overcome challenges and reach solutions
- Fostered relationships between teams and stakeholders
- 1:1s with team members, performance recognition and recruitment.

Senior UI Engineer - MAGO (Manchester Airports Group Online)

May 2020 - October 2021 | Manchester, UK

- VueJS, JavaScript, AWS, DynamoDB, Razor, Git, Bitbucket, Docker, Tailwind, Octopus
- Front-end delivery of the white label booking journey and supporting Admin/Contact Centre (extranet) platforms
- Working closely with the UX, Product and Delivery teams

Earlier Career

Senior Developer / Squad Lead roles across Mojo Mortgages, Havas Lynx and PasTest Ltd (2009–2020), building reliable, mission-critical software products that customers depend on.